Prism Diagnostic — Product Definition (v2)

Executive Summary

The Prism Diagnostic is a $2,499 productized operational audit for founder-led businesses doing $500k to $5M in annual revenue. Over two to three weeks, a delivery team interviews the founder and key staff, maps two to three of the company's most important workflows, audits the operating stack, and delivers a written 90-day action plan that identifies where time, margin, and managerial attention are leaking.

The product is intentionally designed as a tripwire engagement, not a standalone profit center. The diagnostic is priced to be easy to buy and is delivered profitably from India, but the unit economics of the business depend on converting a significant share of diagnostic customers into larger follow-on engagements. This document defines the product, the delivery model, the sales motion, and the follow-on architecture that makes the business model work.

1. Strategic Architecture: Why This Is a Tripwire

The Prism Diagnostic is a deliberately designed customer acquisition product. The diagnostic itself generates thin positive margin per engagement after India-based delivery costs. The real economic value of the product is that it creates qualified, trust-aligned customers who are well-positioned to buy larger follow-on engagements where the company has identified specific operational problems and recommended specific paths to fix them.

Three commitments follow from this architecture and are non-negotiable:

An attach-rate target is explicit, not aspirational. Within 60 days of the diagnostic readout, the company targets a 25–35% conversion to a paid follow-on engagement. This metric is the single most important indicator of business health. If attach rate falls below the floor, the diagnostic loses money rather than acquires customers.

A pre-built follow-on catalog exists and is in the hands of sales and delivery at all times. The follow-on conversation does not begin from a blank page after the readout. Specific offers with named price points, timelines, and outcomes are designed in advance and are introduced naturally during the diagnostic engagement and at the readout itself.

The sales motion treats the diagnostic as customer acquisition cost, not as the primary revenue event. Sales reps are measured both on diagnostic deals closed and on attach to follow-on engagements. Comp structure should reflect this dual focus. Discounting or over-promising on the diagnostic to close it harms the back end and is not a tradeoff sales should make.

2. Target Customer

The Prism Diagnostic is sold to founder-led or owner-operated businesses, anywhere in the world, with annual revenue between $500k and $5M. Headcount is typically 10 to 40 people. Industry is secondary — the product is suitable for marketing agencies, SaaS companies, e-commerce brands, staffing firms, logistics businesses, light manufacturers, professional services firms, and similar.

The buyer is almost always the founder, owner, or CEO. At the upper end of the revenue band, a COO or head of operations may participate in the buying decision, but the founder remains the economic decision-maker. The product is not sold to procurement departments or via RFP.

The best-fit customer profile has most of the following characteristics:

- Several core systems in use (CRM, accounting, project management, support, communication, e-commerce, spreadsheets)

- Repeatable workflows that have grown organically without intentional design
- Visible manual coordination, data re-entry between tools, or workarounds in messaging threads and spreadsheets
- A founder who remains a bottleneck for approvals, exceptions, oversight, or status tracking
- A subjective sense that revenue is outpacing operational clarity

Companies below $500k typically lack the operational complexity for the diagnostic to produce meaningful findings. Companies above $5M typically need a broader transformation engagement rather than a fixed-scope diagnostic.

Geographic targeting

The company sells across five regional markets with one sales rep per region. Each rep covers their natural network and territory:

- **Nigeria rep:** Nigeria and Ghana
- **Rwanda rep:** East Africa cluster (Kigali, Nairobi, Kampala, Dar es Salaam)
- **India rep:** India domestic plus GCC outbound (UAE, Saudi Arabia, Qatar)
- **Colombia rep:** Spanish-speaking Latin America (Mexico, Colombia, Chile, Peru, Central America)
- **US rep:** United States (inbound and partner-referral lean initially)

Brazil and Portuguese-speaking markets are deferred to a future hire or partner relationship. Francophone Africa is deferred similarly. The English-and-Spanish coverage above is the initial footprint.

3. The Customer Pain

The diagnostic addresses a recognizable pattern in companies that have grown past micro-business stage but have not yet built operational discipline. The founder feels the pain but cannot fully articulate it. Common phrases that signal the buying conversation:

- “We’re growing, but it’s getting harder, not easier.”
- “Everything still runs through me.”
- “We have a lot of tools, but they don’t work together.”
- “We don’t know where the bottlenecks really are.”
- “We want to automate, but I’m not sure we’re ready.”
- “Revenue is up, but operations feel messy and slow.”

These phrases map directly to the underlying pathology: fragmented operating systems, founder dependence, manual coordination overhead, tool overlap and underuse, and the absence of designed workflows. The diagnostic exists to give that pathology a name, a map, and a treatment plan.

4. The Value Proposition

The customer is paying $2,499 for three distinct but compounding kinds of value.

Direct cost savings. A founder spending ten hours a week unblocking their team is burning real money in their own time. A few of the diagnostic’s recommendations typically cut that burden meaningfully. The diagnostic pays for itself in weeks, not quarters.

Avoided expensive mistakes. Companies at this stage are constantly being pitched to buy more software, hire more people, or layer in automation. The diagnostic often reveals that the operational foundation is not ready for that next layer, preventing the customer from making a $20k–$50k mistake on premature investment.

Clarity itself. This is the value reason that closes most deals. Founders at this stage feel stuck without being able to articulate why. The diagnostic gives them language, a map, and a sequenced path forward. The emotional value of clarity exceeds the rational value of the cost savings for most buyers, and sales reps should be trained to surface this.

The product is best positioned as *clarity in two weeks for the price of a business-class flight.*

5. Scope: Included and Excluded

Included

- Kickoff session with founder and key leaders
- Async intake questionnaire
- 4–6 structured stakeholder interviews (60 minutes each)
- Stack inventory and visual operating stack map
- Workflow analysis and diagrams for 2–3 selected workflows
- Synthesis of findings: tool overlap, manual work, bottlenecks, founder dependencies, workarounds
- Written 90-day action plan with 5–10 prioritized actions, categorized as Stop, Fix, Simplify, Integrate, or Prepare
- Live readout session (90 minutes)
- Recorded video walkthrough of findings (15–20 minutes)
- Optional 30-day check-in call

Excluded from the base engagement

- Tool implementation, migration, or configuration
- Custom integration or automation development
- Process documentation or SOP writing
- Hands-on execution of the action plan
- Ongoing operational management or fractional executive support
- Strategic, financial, or legal consulting outside operational scope

This exclusion list is critical for sales clarity. Customers who confuse the diagnostic with implementation will be disappointed at delivery and will request refunds. Sales must be explicit at qualification and close: *we tell you exactly what to do, in what order, with confidence — but we don't do it for you in this engagement. We offer follow-on services that will, and we'll discuss those at the readout.*

6. Engagement Timeline

The engagement is structured in four phases across approximately 10–15 business days.

Phase	Days	Objective
Kickoff and intake	1–3	Align scope, collect baseline, schedule interviews
Interviews and mapping	3–8	Understand how work and data actually move
Analysis and design	8–13	Identify leakage, design 90-day plan
Readout and handover	13–15	Present findings, plant follow-on seed

7. Deliverables

Each engagement produces five customer-facing artifacts:

1. **Operating Stack Map** — a one-page visual representation of the customer's tool ecosystem, showing what's used, by whom, for what, and where connections are missing.
2. **Workflow Diagrams** — current-state maps of two to three critical workflows, identifying handoffs, manual steps, founder dependencies, and friction points.
3. **90-Day Action Plan** — five to ten prioritized actions grouped by category (Stop / Fix / Simplify / Integrate / Prepare), each with rationale, effort estimate, expected impact, and suggested owner.
4. **Final Report Deck** — a structured slide deck presenting findings, recommendations, and the action plan.
5. **Recorded Loom Walkthrough** — a 15–20 minute video that the customer can replay or share internally.

8. The Follow-On Engagement Catalog

This catalog is the load-bearing element of the tripwire architecture. Every diagnostic ends with a clear, specific recommendation for the highest-leverage next step, drawn from this catalog. Sales reps and delivery consultants are trained to introduce these offers naturally during the engagement and to formalize the recommendation at the readout.

Workflow Redesign Sprint — $8k–$15k, 4–6 weeks. Takes one or two workflows identified in the diagnostic and rebuilds them end-to-end: defines roles, eliminates manual steps where possible, documents the new flow, and supports the team through a transition. Typical fit: customers whose primary pain is internal coordination chaos in a specific function.

Stack Rationalization Project — $15k–$30k, 6–10 weeks. Consolidates the customer's software stack, eliminates duplicate tools, identifies and implements key integrations, configures underused tools properly, and ends with a leaner, more connected operating environment. Typical fit: customers paying for too many tools or with serious data fragmentation between systems.

Automation Implementation — $20k–$40k, 8–12 weeks. Builds specific automations identified in the diagnostic, typically using a combination of native integrations and lightweight middleware. Includes documentation and team training. Typical fit: customers whose foundation is reasonable but whose manual work is at scale.

90-Day Execution Partner — $12k–$25k, 12 weeks. Partners with the customer to execute the diagnostic's action plan, providing weekly working sessions, progress tracking, and accountability. Typical fit: customers with the right priorities but no internal capacity to drive execution.

Fractional Operations Lead — $5k–$10k/month, ongoing. Embedded part-time operations leadership for customers who need sustained support rather than a project. Typical fit: customers without an internal head of operations who need more than a project's worth of help.

Pricing is in USD across all regions. Specific scoping happens after the diagnostic, but anchor prices are committed to in advance so sales reps can credibly discuss them at close and at readout.

9. Sales Model

Sales motion

The diagnostic is sold on a high-velocity motion appropriate to its price point. Specifically:

- 1-call close is the target. Multi-call discovery is acceptable only when complexity warrants it.
- Qualification is gated upstream. A 5–7 question form precedes any sales call. Reps do not invest time in unqualified prospects.
- No SDR-to-AE handoff. The rep who takes discovery closes the deal.

- Pipeline volume target is 8–15 closed diagnostics per region per month at full ramp.

Qualification criteria

A prospect is a strong fit if most of the following are true:

- Revenue is between $500k and $5M
- Headcount is 10–40
- The business runs on multiple software tools and has repeatable workflows
- The founder or owner is participating in the conversation
- The customer can articulate at least one specific operational pain in their own words
- Budget for follow-on work is plausibly available within 60–90 days

Disqualifying signals include: revenue well below $500k, single-person businesses, shopping-for-a-vendor procurement processes, prospects unwilling to commit to 4–6 stakeholder interviews, and prospects whose stated need is implementation rather than diagnosis.

Pricing and payment

Pricing is $2,499 USD, flat, no discounting. Regional payment infrastructure must support: Paystack (Nigeria), Flutterwave (East Africa), local rails or USD wire (India), USD wire and standard cards (GCC and US), and MercadoPago or USD wire (Spanish LatAm). USD wire serves as the universal fallback.

Comp structure

Sales reps are compensated on two metrics, not one: diagnostic deals closed, and follow-on engagements attached. Commission on follow-on should be meaningful enough that reps are incentivized to position the diagnostic well, set honest expectations, and stay engaged through the readout. Specific structure is set by leadership; the principle is that reps cannot win by closing the front end at the expense of the back end.

10. Delivery Model

Delivery is based in India and operates with a two-person core team per engagement, plus optional senior review.

Lead Consultant — owns client relationship, runs interviews, leads synthesis and analysis, presents the readout. Approximately 18–25 hours per engagement. This is the senior-judgment seat and must be staffed with consultants who can credibly engage with Western, Middle Eastern, African, and Latin American founders. English fluency, cross-cultural ease, and operational pattern recognition are all required.

Analyst — owns structured documentation, builds stack inventory, drafts workflow diagrams, supports synthesis, prepares the final report. Approximately 25–35 hours per engagement.

Optional Technical Advisor — provides 2–4 hours of senior review on stack and integration recommendations when the customer's environment warrants it.

Total delivery effort is typically 50–65 hours per engagement. Templates, intake automation, and AI-augmented synthesis tooling are used throughout to maintain quality at this hour budget. Templates are tooling, not shortcuts — the synthesis quality is the product, and senior consultants always validate AI-generated recommendations before they go to the customer.

Time zone alignment

Live client touchpoints (kickoff, interviews, readout) are scheduled in the overlap window between India business hours and the customer's market. For GCC, East Africa, and West Africa this overlap is generous. For Spanish LatAm and the US, this overlap is the late evening in India and must be staffed with consultants who can work that schedule consistently.

11. Unit Economics

At fully-loaded Indian delivery rates and 50–65 hours per engagement, delivery cost runs approximately $1,200–$1,800. At a $2,499 price, gross margin per diagnostic is approximately $700–$1,300 (28–50%), before sales and marketing costs.

After loading sales cost (rep base salary, commission, sales overhead) and marketing/CAC, the diagnostic alone is typically break-even to slightly negative on first dollar. The business model only works when the follow-on attach rate clears the floor.

At a 30% attach rate with average follow-on value of $18k and 35% gross margin on follow-on work, every 10 diagnostic engagements generate approximately $19k in expected follow-on gross margin. This is the economic engine of the business. Operating at lower attach rates or smaller follow-on sizes erodes the model fast.

12. Success Metrics

The product is measured on three categories of metrics:

Customer outcomes: customer satisfaction (NPS or equivalent at 30 days post-readout), refund rate (target: under 5%), self-reported implementation rate of recommendations at 60 days, and qualitative testimonial capture.

Business outcomes: diagnostic deals closed per region per month, follow-on attach rate within 60 days (target: 25–35%), average follow-on deal value, time from diagnostic close to follow-on close, and customer lifetime value by region.

Delivery health: hours per engagement (target: 50–65), on-time delivery rate, internal quality review scores, and consultant utilization across the bench.

13. Risks and Mitigations

Delivery quality variance. At 50–65 hours per engagement with templates and AI assistance, every engagement requires tight execution. One sloppy delivery damages the brand more at this price than at a higher one. Mitigation: standardized templates, mandatory senior review at the synthesis stage, quality scorecards on each engagement, and rapid post-mortem on any negative customer feedback.

Refund pressure. SMB buyers at this price point ask for refunds when they feel they overpaid or were misled. Mitigation: a written, public refund policy decided in advance; clear expectation-setting at qualification and close (especially around what’s excluded); and synthesis quality that makes recommendations feel earned and specific, not generic.

Solo-rep regional coverage. Each rep is alone in their region, with no in-region peer to benchmark against. Mitigation: weekly cross-regional sales all-hands where reps share what’s working; tight tracking of first-five-deal close rates by region; and willingness to act fast if a region underperforms persistently.

Bench readiness for cross-cultural delivery. The consultants delivering to Western founders, GCC family business owners, East African SME leaders, and Latin American agency owners need genuine cross-cultural ease and regional stack fluency. Mitigation: monitor refund rates, NPS, and follow-on conversion by region for the first 10 engagements per region. Any region with elevated negative signal triggers a delivery review.

Follow-on engine failure. The entire business model assumes the follow-on attach rate holds. Mitigation: track attach rate as a primary KPI, not a secondary one. Hold weekly leadership reviews on attach for the first six months. If attach is under 20% by month three, the business has a structural problem that requires intervention, not patience.

14. Operating Principles

These principles govern delivery and sales behavior:

- The diagnostic is the entry point, not the destination. Every engagement is designed and delivered with the follow-on in mind.
- Synthesis quality is the product. The PDF is the receipt.
- Scope is fixed. Scope creep on a $2,499 engagement destroys margin instantly.
- Show the real current state. Idealized future operating models are not the product.
- The 90-day plan is honest, specific, and prioritized — not a comprehensive backlog dressed up as advice.
- The follow-on recommendation at the readout is earned, not pushed. If the diagnostic genuinely doesn't warrant follow-on work for a given customer, say so.
- Cross-regional learning is built into the team rhythm. What works in Lagos may work in Riyadh; what fails in Bogotá may save the next deal in Mumbai.

Appendix A: One-Sentence Positioning

The Prism Diagnostic is a $2,499 two-week operational audit that shows founder-led businesses doing $500k–$5M in revenue exactly where their operations are leaking time and margin, and gives them a clear 90-day plan to fix it.

Appendix B: Sales One-Liner

"In two weeks and for $2,499, we map your most painful workflows, audit your stack, and give you a prioritized 90-day plan. If you want help executing it after, we have packages for that too."